"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, dry, light and variable winds, high 66. **Tonight,** clear, light winds, low 50. **Tomorrow,** sunny to partly cloudy, dry, light winds, high 69. Weather map is on Page 20.

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MERIDITH KOHUT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

An Indorama Ventures plant in southeast Texas with a history of releasing pollutants got a waiver from the Trump administration.

After Return, Trump Gave Many Big Polluters a Pass

Over 200 Industrial Facilities Were Granted Exemptions From Clean-Air Rules

By ERIC LIPTON and MAXINE JOSELOW

PORT NECHES, Texas — Within sight of a southeast Texas middle school stands a chemical plant that President Trump excused from new federal rules intended to curb its cancer-causing pollution.

About a 30-minute drive from Pittsburgh, a steel-making facility has spewed carcinogenic chemicals near homes for years. Mr. Trump gave it a similar waiver from recent clean-air rules.

DIRTIER AIR, DIRTIER WATER
Corporate Clout

And on the outskirts of Richmond, Va., the owners of an industrial warehouse emailed the Trump administration asking for their own waiver. Their wish was granted. Nine months later, the facility accidentally released a large plume of carcinogenic gas into the community.

In total, since taking office again, Mr. Trump exempted 202 facilities in 39 states and Puerto Rico from clean-air regulations that were going into effect. Some were among the country's worst industrial polluters, including chemical manufacturers, copper smelters and coal-burning power plants. About 3.3 million people live within three miles of at least one affected facility.

The exemptions represent the biggest presidential intervention in enforcement of the Clean Air Act in the half-century since President Richard M. Nixon signed the bedrock environmental law. And that is only one of the ways the Trump administration is dismantling a variety of federal environmental protections.

Before Mr. Trump's return, the chemical industry was losing its fight to block or at least delay tougher E.P.A. requirements to reduce toxic emissions. It had pleaded with agency officials, filed lawsuits and appealed to Congress. But officials and the courts had largely rejected the industry's claims of undue expense and regulatory overreach.

Now, Mr. Trump is prioritizing the economic interests of corporations and easing costs for polluting industries, and their immense clout is striking.

The president's exemptions were good for two years, with the possibility of an extension. The reprieve for the companies gave Mr. Trump time to stock the Environmental Protection Agency with appointees who had lobbied for the industries they now regulate. Those officials then quickly went to work from the inside to gut the rules altogether.

Mr. Trump has taken an expansive view of executive power in his second term. On the environmental front, he has unilaterally shredded regulations, withheld science funding appropriated by Congress and ordered coal plants that planned to shutter to continue

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Ruthless Ad Divides G.O.P. and Jolts Ohio Governor's Race

By REID J. EPSTEIN and CAMPBELL ROBERTSON

The most explosive advertisement of the midterm elections has split Republicans and again posed the question of what is fair game for campaign attacks in American politics.

In the days since the leak of the ad from Vivek Ramaswamy, the Republican nominee for governor of Ohio, many fellow G.O.P. politicians have denounced, disavowed or distanced themselves from the spot. Yet President Trump and Vice President JD Vance have defended the ad, a remarkably ruthless one even by the standards of modern political campaigns.

The ad features the estranged mother of Mr. Ramaswamy's Democratic opponent, Amy Acton, calling her daughter a liar and urging Ohioans not to vote for her. Dr. Acton has said that she has not spoken to her mother since she was 12 years old, when she was removed from her mother's custody after her stepfather was arrested and charged with raping her.

Rethinking Red Lines of Political Warfare

The outrage over the ad's dark backstory has left Mr. Ramaswamy, a billionaire entrepreneur who exemplifies the anything-goes, attack-at-all-costs ethos of Trump-era politics, at the center of a self-created political firestorm.

The Republican disagreements

Continued on Page 21

Abuse Claims Will Be Settled By Archdiocese

By MAYA KING and JEFFERY C. MAYS

The Archdiocese of New York and plaintiffs' lawyers have reached an agreement on a proposed settlement in which the church would pay more than $800 million to settle claims from 1,300 people who said they had been sexually abused by its clergy members and lay leaders.

The plaintiffs' lawyers said late on Friday that they had agreed upon the settlement with the archdiocese and that all of the plaintiffs had signed off on it.

In an email to the priests of the archdiocese shared with The New York Times, Archbishop Ronald A. Hicks confirmed on Saturday that an agreement had been reached to settle the claims. He said the deal would not be final until the plaintiffs, lawyers and representatives for the archdiocese signed the settlement, which they were scheduled to do in early November.

"We are on the verge of being able to, please God, bring some measure of healing and reconciliation to all victim-survivors," he said in the message, adding that the agreement "will also allow the archdiocese to turn its full attention once again to its mission of preaching the Gospel, healing the sick, caring for the poor and needy, welcoming the stranger, and educating our children."

Terms of the settlement would call for each plaintiff to have the option of receiving a lump-sum payment of at least $250,000, or a

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A SPECIAL SECTION

When the Weed Wars Came to Warren Street





PHOTOGRAPHS BY KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

The war on drugs devastated the Black community in Hudson, N.Y. Decades later, the state began an experiment: legalizing marijuana to heal the drug war's harms. Could this be done in today's Hudson, a mecca of boho chic? And who will reap the rewards — a native son of Hudson, Bill Hughes, or Joanne Wilson, a wealthy outsider?

Crafting Image of Mr. Security, He Asks to Keep Israel's Trust

By ISABEL KERSHNER

HOLON, Israel — Benjamin Netanyahu looks thinner and paler these days. Gone is the swagger of previous political campaigns. But he remains tireless, traipsing among shopping centers and television studios, trying to persuade a weary and polarized country to return him to office for up to another four years in Israeli elections on Tuesday.

At 77, he is already Israel's longest-serving prime minister. If he is to extend that tenure, he has to sell the deeply divided electorate on the new, more hawkish version of himself — and of Israel.

Mr. Netanyahu's career will forever be defined by the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks on southern Israel, the deadliest day for Jews since the Holocaust. He long had a reputation for being risk averse and avoiding military confrontations, even as he cultivated an image as Israel's Mr. Security. But that image, as well as Israel's confidence in its own defense, was badly damaged that day.

So Mr. Netanyahu, known by friends and foes as Bibi, reinvented himself. Instead of sticking to Israel's previous security doctrine centered on short wars of defense, he has waged Israel's longest war on multiple fronts — against Hamas in Gaza, Hezbollah militants in Lebanon, the Houthi militia in Yemen and, together with the United States, Iran.



ITAI RON/REUTERS

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu seeks re-election.

He has doubled down on Israel's

Continued on Page 8

CRACKDOWN The Israeli military raided Hebron a day after the killing of two soldiers. PAGE 9

Thanks to the Data Center Boom, Times Have Never Been So Good for Gray Paint

By EMMY MARTIN

PITTSBURGH — In a concrete building known as "the bunker," researchers at PPG, a $24 billion company that makes paints, aimed torches at steel panels that were covered in a gray coating.

Paul Fenton, a PPG chemist and engineer, held up one panel after it had been blasted with flames. The paint had swelled from a millimeter thick into a black crust nearly 10 millimeters tall. That meant the coating had done its job: The thick crust had kept any fire from reaching the underlying steel and softening it.

"Just like a toasted marshmallow likes to expand," said Mr. Fenton, who wore a lab coat and safety goggles over wire-frame glasses. The trapped air, he said, "keeps everything cold."

The paint that Mr. Fenton showed off, called Steelguard 951, has become one of PPG's flagship products for data centers — and its sales have boomed. As Microsoft, Google, Amazon and other tech giants have raced to build the computing sites powering the artificial intelligence frenzy, PPG's business has also soared.

The Pittsburgh company said it expected its paint sales for data centers to triple this year from last year. That would far outpace the company as a whole, whose total sales grew 7 percent to $4.5 billion in the most recent quarter.

"I've never seen a boom as big as this," said Jenn Solcz, PPG's vice president of protective and

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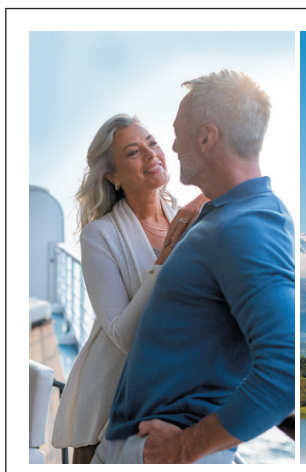
Jeffrey Schmalz took on the role of chronicling the AIDS epidemic for The Times — even as the disease was ruining his own health. PAGE 17

ARTS & LEISURE
Top Television: They Told Us
We asked hundreds of stars, writers and other industry experts to vote for the best series that have premiered since Jan. 1, 2000. PAGE 8

T MAGAZINE
The Greats
This year, the honorees are an artist, a rapper, an actor and a photographer — all of whom have inspired others by staying true to themselves.

SUNDAY BUSINESS
Warning Signs in the Markets
Nearly 20 years have passed since the global financial meltdown of 2007-9. It's not impossible to spot the characteristics of another brewing crisis. PAGE 4

SUNDAY OPINION
Dan Wang PAGE 6




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